

ENTERTAIN

1. Passage anchor

> “Overall, I am very glad I read it, because it was not only ****entertaining**** but also quietly meaningful...”

Passage meaning

****entertaining**** = enjoyable, interesting, or amusing in a way that keeps someone interested
****有娛樂性的；有趣的；令人享受的****

Here, the speaker means the novel was enjoyable to read, while also having deeper emotional meaning.

Practice

1. The book is thoughtful but still very ****entertaining****.
這本書很有思想，但同時也非常****有趣好看****。

2. The film was surprisingly ****entertaining****.
這部電影出乎意料地****有娛樂性****。

Core meanings of ENTERTAIN

2. entertain — amuse / provide enjoyment

= provide someone with enjoyment, amusement, or interest
****娛樂；使愉快；使感到有趣****

This is the core branch behind the passage adjective ****entertaining****.

Examples

1. The show ****entertained**** the audience for two hours.
這場表演****娛樂了觀眾****兩個小時。

2. The children were ****entertained**** by the magician.
孩子們被魔術師逗得很****開心****。

3. entertain someone

= keep someone amused or interested

****使某人得到娛樂；逗某人開心****

Examples

1. We told stories to ****entertain the children****.

我們講故事來****逗孩子們開心****。

2. The performer knows how to ****entertain a crowd****.

這位表演者很懂得如何****娛樂觀眾****。

Host guests

4. entertain — receive guests socially

= invite people to your home or another place and provide food, drink, conversation, etc.

****招待；款待****

Examples

1. They often ****entertain friends at home****.

他們常在家中****招待朋友****。

2. She loves ****entertaining guests****.

她很喜歡****款待客人****。

Major distinct sense.

5. entertain at home

= host people socially in your home

****在家招待客人****

Examples

1. They prefer to ****entertain at home**** rather than eat out.

他們比較喜歡****在家招待客人****，而不是外出用餐。

2. The kitchen was designed for people who enjoy ****entertaining at home****.

這個廚房是為喜歡****在家宴客****的人設計的。

Consider an idea

6. entertain an idea / thought

= consider an idea seriously or allow yourself to think that it might be possible

****考慮某個想法；心存某種念頭****

Examples

1. She briefly ****entertained the idea of moving abroad****.

她曾短暫****考慮過移居海外的念頭****。

2. I never seriously ****entertained the thought**** of quitting.

我從未認真****考慮過辭職這個念頭****。

This is a very important formal figurative sense.

7. entertain the possibility

= consider that something might happen or be true

****考慮某種可能性****

Examples

1. We have to ****entertain the possibility**** that the plan may fail.

我們必須****考慮計畫可能失敗這個可能性****。

2. He refused to ****entertain the possibility**** that he might be wrong.

他拒絕****考慮自己可能錯了這種可能性****。

8. entertain doubts / hopes

= allow a doubt, hope, suspicion, etc. to exist in your mind

****心存疑慮 / 希望等****

Examples

1. She began to ****entertain doubts**** about the decision.

她開始對這個決定****心存疑慮****。

2. He still ****entertained hopes**** of returning one day.

他仍然**抱著有一天能回去的希望**。

More formal/literary.

Consider a request / proposal

9. entertain a proposal / request / application

Formal:

= be willing to consider or discuss something officially

考慮 / 受理提議、要求、申請等

Examples

1. The committee agreed to **entertain the proposal**.

委員會同意**考慮這項提議**。

2. The company will not **entertain requests** submitted after the deadline.

公司不會**受理**截止日期後提交的要求。

Distinct institutional/formal use.

10. refuse to entertain something

= refuse even to consider or discuss it

拒絕考慮；不予受理

Examples

1. She refused to **entertain the suggestion**.

她拒絕**考慮那項建議**。

2. The court declined to **entertain the application**.

法院拒絕**受理該申請**。

Related forms

11. entertaining

= enjoyable, amusing, or interesting

****有娛樂性的；有趣的；吸引人的****

This is the exact passage form.

Examples

1. It was an ****entertaining**** lecture.

那是一場很****有趣的****講座。

2. The novel is both intelligent and ****entertaining****.

這本小說既有深度又****好看有趣****。

12. entertained

A. amused / interested

****感到愉快的；被逗樂的****

1. The audience seemed thoroughly ****entertained****.

觀眾似乎都看得非常****開心****。

B. considered mentally

In constructions such as:

> entertained the idea

the verb means ****考慮 / 心存某念頭****, not “amused.”

13. entertainment

A. activity or performance providing enjoyment

****娛樂；娛樂活動****

1. The hotel provides evening ****entertainment****.

酒店提供晚間****娛樂活動****。

B. entertainment industry/content

****娛樂業；娛樂內容****

2. She works in the **entertainment industry**.

她在**娛樂業**工作。

14. entertainer

= person whose job is to amuse an audience, such as a performer, comedian, singer, etc.

藝人；表演者；娛樂者

Examples

1. He began his career as a street **entertainer**.

他最初是一名街頭**表演者**。

2. She is a natural **entertainer**.

她天生就很會**逗觀眾開心**。

Entertainment media

15. entertainment — films, television, music, games, etc.

= media and activities created primarily for enjoyment

娛樂內容；娛樂媒體

Examples

1. Streaming has changed the way people consume **entertainment**.

串流服務改變了人們消費**娛樂內容**的方式。

2. Games are a major form of digital **entertainment**.

遊戲是數位**娛樂**的重要形式。

Hospitality / business

16. entertainment expenses

= money spent on hosting clients, guests, etc. for business purposes

應酬費；招待費

Examples

1. Employees must record business **entertainment expenses**.
員工必須記錄商務**應酬費**。

2. The policy limits client **entertainment**.
該政策限制客戶**招待支出**。

This grows from the “host guests” sense rather than the amusement sense.

High-value patterns

17. entertain yourself

= keep yourself occupied or amused
自娛；自己找樂子

Examples

1. He **entertained himself** by reading.
他靠閱讀**自娛**。

2. The children found ways to **entertain themselves**.
孩子們找到方法**自己玩樂**。

18. entertain an audience

= perform for an audience in a way that gives enjoyment
娛樂觀眾

Examples

1. The band **entertained the audience** all evening.
樂隊整晚都在**娛樂觀眾**。

2. Her stories easily **entertain an audience**.
她的故事很容易讓觀眾**聽得津津有味**。

19. entertain guests

= host and look after visitors socially

****招待客人****

Examples

1. The room is large enough to ****entertain guests****.
這個房間夠大，可以****招待客人****。
2. They frequently ****entertain guests**** at weekends.
他們週末經常****宴客****。

Important contrast with ****entertain an audience****.

Key contrasts

20. entertain vs amuse

****amuse****

= make someone laugh, smile, or find something funny/enjoyable

****逗樂；使覺得有趣****

****entertain****

= broader: provide enjoyment or hold interest, not necessarily through humor

****娛樂；使感興趣****

Compare:

> The joke amused me.

> 那個笑話把我逗笑了。

> The film entertained me.

> 那部電影讓我看得很投入、很享受。

21. entertaining vs funny

****funny****

= causes laughter

****好笑的****

****entertaining****

= enjoyable or interesting

****有趣的；有娛樂性的****

Something can be entertaining without being funny.

A mystery novel may be **entertaining** but not **funny**.

22. entertaining vs engaging

This is especially useful because both occur in the passage.

engaging

= captures and holds attention

引人入勝的；吸引人的

entertaining

= gives enjoyment or amusement

有娛樂性的；有趣好看的

Compare:

> an **engaging** story

> → 讓人投入、想一直讀下去

> an **entertaining** story

> → 讓人讀得愉快、享受

They often overlap, but the emphasis differs.

23. entertain vs host

host

= receive guests or organize an event

主持；作東；招待

entertain

= when used socially, emphasizes providing hospitality and enjoyment to guests

款待；宴客

Compare:

> host a conference

> 主辦 / 主持會議

> entertain guests at home

> 在家款待客人

24. entertain vs consider

****consider****

= general neutral word for thinking carefully about something

****考慮****

****entertain****

= more formal when meaning “allow an idea or possibility into consideration”

Compare:

> consider moving abroad

> 考慮搬到海外

> entertain the idea of moving abroad

> 心中開始考慮搬到海外這個念頭

25. entertain vs believe

****entertain an idea****

does not necessarily mean you believe it.

It means you are willing to ****consider it mentally****.

Compare:

> I entertained the possibility that he was right.

> 我考慮過他可能是對的。

This does not mean:

> I believed he was right.

> 我相信他是對的。

Meaning map

The modern senses of ****entertain**** divide into several clear branches.

Enjoyment

entertain an audience

→ **娛樂觀眾**

Passage

entertaining novel

→ **有趣好看的小說**

Hospitality

entertain guests

→ **招待客人**

Thought

entertain an idea

→ **考慮一個想法**

Possibility

entertain the possibility

→ **考慮某種可能性**

Formal consideration

entertain a proposal

→ **考慮 / 受理提議**

The family extends naturally:

entertainment

→ **娛樂；娛樂活動**

entertainer

→ **藝人 / 表演者**

entertaining

→ **有趣的；有娛樂性的**

The passage uses the **enjoyment** branch:

> the book was **entertaining**
> → **這本書讀起來有趣、令人享受**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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entertain — amuse/provide enjoyment	讓某人感到愉快、有趣或得到娛樂
entertain someone	使某人保持興趣、得到娛樂或享受
entertain an audience	透過表演等讓觀眾得到娛樂
entertain — host guests	在家或其他場合款待、招待客人
entertain at home	在自己家中宴客 / 招待朋友
entertain guests	為客人提供飲食、交流等款待
entertain an idea/thought	把某個想法納入考慮；心存某念頭
entertain the possibility	考慮某事可能發生或成立
entertain doubts/hopes	心中存有疑慮 / 希望
entertain a proposal/request	正式考慮或受理提議、要求等
refuse to entertain something	連考慮 / 討論某事也拒絕；不予受理
entertaining	能帶來享受並保持興趣的；有娛樂性 / 有趣的
entertained	因活動、表演等而感到愉快或有興趣的
entertainment — activity	供人消遣、享受的娛樂 / 娛樂活動
entertainment — media/industry	電影、音樂、遊戲等娛樂內容 / 娛樂業
entertainer	以表演來娛樂觀眾的藝人 / 表演者
entertainment expenses	商務上招待客戶等產生的應酬 / 招待費
entertain yourself	自己找活動消遣；自娛

Passage recap

> “...it was not only **entertaining** but also quietly meaningful...”

Here:

entertaining = **enjoyable and interesting in a way that makes the reading experience pleasant**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **有娛樂性的**

* **有趣的**

* **好看的**

* contextually: **讀起來令人享受的**

Natural contextual translation:

****因為它不但有趣好看，也帶著一種安靜而深刻的意義。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****entertaining****

= ****enjoyable or interesting enough to give someone pleasure and keep them interested****

****有趣的；有娛樂性的；令人享受的****

The most useful passage distinction is:

> ****engaging****

> → ****能抓住注意力，讓人投入****

while:

> ****entertaining****

> → ****能讓人享受閱讀過程，覺得有趣好看****

And the base verb has two easily tested meanings that are far removed from entertainment:

> ****entertain guests****

> → 款待客人

> ****entertain an idea****

> → 考慮某個想法

So ****entertain**** should not automatically be translated as ****娛樂****. The construction determines the meaning.